

TEMPO

Music bingo by Liquid Courage

New Host Guide

Running a full event, from prep to last call — multiple rounds included

Build rounds → Set round → Start game → Verify bingo → Next round

What's inside

1. How a TEMPO night works
2. One-time setup & your defaults
3. Building rounds (playlists)
4. Pre-show: the Game tab cockpit
5. Setting and starting a round
6. Running live play
7. Bingo calls & verification
8. Between rounds & ending the night
9. Quick reference & troubleshooting

1 · How a TEMPO night works

TEMPO is music bingo. Instead of numbers, every square on a player's card is a **song**. You play short clips from Spotify; players who recognize a song find it on their card (on their phone) and tap it. First verified pattern wins the round.

The three screens

Screen	Who sees it	What it does
Host view	You only	Build rounds, control playback, verify bingos. Tabs: Game Rounds Players Display Settings
Public display	Projector / TV	Splash screen with QR join code before play; the live call list during play (song titles reveal gradually)
Player view	Each player's phone	Their bingo card; they tap squares as songs play and call BINGO from there

Nights, rounds, and playlists

A night is made of **rounds** (plan up to 12). Each round uses **exactly 1 or exactly 5 playlists** — nothing in between:

- **1 playlist (Round Mix):** all 75 card songs come from one big playlist. Simple, classic.
- **5 playlists (Columns):** each playlist owns one card column. Players know which theme each column is — a great hook for themed rounds.

B
80s Hits

I
One-Hit Wonders

N
Movie Themes

G
Country Gold

O
2010s Pop

OPTION — YOUR OWN LETTERS

The column letters don't have to be B-I-N-G-O. In [Settings](#) → Defaults → **Column letters**, set any five letters (T-E-M-P-O, T-O-N-E-S...). They appear on cards, the projector, and printed cards.

KEY CONCEPT — ONE SHUFFLE PER ROUND

When you press [Start game](#), TEMPO shuffles the round's 75 songs into one play order (#1–75). The host list, the projector call numbers, and playback all follow that same order for the whole round.

2 · One-time setup & your defaults

- 1 Sign in** with your approved host account and create a room. Your room code is what players and the projector connect to.
- 2 Connect Spotify** from the Connection panel (in the header, or [Settings](#) → Playback & connections). You need **Spotify Premium**. Music plays on whichever Spotify device you pick — the venue PC, a tablet, your phone.
- 3 Pick a playback device.** Open Spotify on the device you want, then choose it in the Connection panel. An *idle* device is fine — TEMPO transfers playback to it automatically at Start game. Only *offline* devices need attention (tap Refresh devices after waking it).
- 4 Set your defaults** in [Settings](#). These save to your account, so they follow you to every event and device.

Settings worth knowing (all optional — defaults work fine)

Setting	What it controls	Options
Snippet length	How long each song clip plays	5–60 seconds (20–30s typical)
Snippet start	Where in the track the clip starts	From start · Early random · Random
Reveal titles on projector	How masked song titles fill in on the call list	By letter (timed) · Full at clip start · Full at clip end
Letter reveal interval	Seconds between random letter reveals (letter mode)	5–120 seconds
Letter reveal toast	"Revealed: ..." banner on the projector	On / Off
Column letters	The five letters on cards & call list	Any 5 letters (default BINGO)
Playlist title flags	Which playlists show in the shared library's "picks" filter	Comma-separated tags (e.g. GoT)
Hybrid	In-person + online players in one game	On / Off

3 · Building rounds — the Rounds tab

This is your planning workspace. Do it before doors open — it autosaves to your account as you go.

- 1 **Browse the Playlist Library.** You'll see the shared Tempo library plus your own Spotify playlists. Use the picks/All toggle to filter to curated lists.
- 2 **Assign playlists to rounds.** Three ways:
 - **Drag** a playlist onto a round chip in "Tonight's rounds"
 - **Double-click** a playlist to add it to the currently focused round
 - Use the playlist's **assign menu** to pick specific rounds
- 3 **Respect the 1-or-5 rule.** A round must end at exactly 1 or exactly 5 playlists. With 5, the order you set = the card column order, left to right.
- 4 **Set each round's card rules** (you can also do this later in Step 2 of the cockpit): win pattern, lines required, free space.
- 5 **Save your rounds.** [Save all and return to Game](#) snapshots every eligible round so cards and pools are ready to deal instantly at showtime.

Options while planning

- **Reusing a playlist** in two rounds is allowed — you'll see a caution badge so it's a deliberate choice.
- **Leftovers** is a virtual playlist of every song that *hasn't been played yet tonight* — a fun closer round.
- **Printables:** per round you can download printed card PDFs (pick how many, watermark-preview first) and a host **call sheet**. Useful for paper-card venues or backup.
- **Add / remove rounds** any time before they're played (up to 12).

4 · Pre-show — the Game tab cockpit

The Game tab walks you through three steps: **Playlist** → **Card setup** → **Play game**. "Tonight's rounds" at the top always shows your plan — click a round to load it for prep.

Step 1 · Playlist

Confirms what music the focused round uses. If you planned in the Rounds tab this is already done — it just shows the round's playlists and pool size.

Step 2 · Card setup

Option	Choices
Win pattern	Line (1+ lines, you choose how many) · Full card · Custom patterns (draw your own shape; rotation/mirror matching optional) · Combined patterns
Free space	On/off — center square free
Clip settings	Snippet length & start (defaults from Settings, override per event)

Step 3 · Play game — the readiness check

A pre-show checklist confirms, live:

- **Playback connected** (Spotify linked)
- **Spotify device ready** — "idle" is OK; it activates at Start game
- **Projector display connected** — open **/display/YOURROOM** on the venue screen if not
- **Bingo pool built** — use **Build song pool** if you didn't save the round earlier
- **Round structure valid** (1 or 5 playlists)

ACTIVATE THE EVENT

If your org uses event credits, activate the event from Step 3 (or Settings) before starting Round 1. Trials and unlimited plans just confirm.

MEANWHILE, ON THE PROJECTOR...

The splash screen shows the room QR code and join URL. Players scan, enter a name, and wait — they get cards when you set the round.

5 · Setting and starting a round

- 1 **Press** **Set round** (Step 3, once the round is ready). This deals player cards and replaces the splash with the **call list** — five columns with this round's playlist names as headers. Nothing is playing yet.
- 2 **Break down the round for the crowd.** This is your mic moment: explain the themes, the win pattern, how many lines, free space, how title reveals work. Players are looking at their fresh cards while you talk.
- 3 Need the QR back? **Back to splash** returns the join screen — late arrivals can still scan. Set round again when you're ready.
- 4 **Press** **Start game**. TEMPO shuffles the play order, transfers playback to your Spotify device, and clip #1 begins. From here the live dashboard takes over.

6 · Running live play

During a round the Game tab becomes a live dashboard: current track, round progress (played / remaining), player count, and playback controls.

Control	What it does
Pause / Resume	Stops and restarts the clip clock and Spotify playback
Replay clip	Plays the current song's clip again
Mark played / skip	Logs the current song and moves to the next in order

What players see: each clip, they hunt their card and tap matches. **What the projector shows:** each played song joins the call list with its call number; titles start masked and reveal per your reveal mode, so latecomers can't just read answers.

GOOD HABITS

- Stay on whatever tab you like — playback won't yank you back to Game.
- You can keep prepping later rounds on the Rounds tab mid-game; browsing rounds never moves the live round.
- If a song title is wrong or has multiple valid titles, you can edit titles/aliases from the host pool list.

7 · Bingo calls & verification

- 1 A player taps **BINGO** on their phone. Playback pauses automatically and a verification alert appears for you (claims queue first-in, first-out if several land at once).
- 2 **Open verification.** You'll see the player's full card with their marked squares, validated against the round's pattern and the songs actually played.
- 3 **Approve** if it's legit — the round ends, the winner celebration shows, and the projector announces it. **Reject** if not (wrong squares, pattern not met) — play resumes where you left off.

AFTER AN APPROVED BINGO — YOUR OPTIONS

- **Back to host** — close the celebration, decide later (round is marked complete)
- **Prepare next round (no auto-start)** — loads the next planned round for review; start it when ready (recommended)
- **Start next planned round now** — jumps straight in
- **Start next round** (fresh) — resets to a blank setup if you want to improvise a round

8 · Between rounds & ending the night

The multi-round loop

For each later round, the rhythm repeats:

Prepare next round → **review Step 3 checklist** → **Set round** (new cards + new headers) → **explain** → **Start game**

Players keep their connection between rounds — they get a fresh card automatically each time you set a round. The projector flips back to the new call list.

Event actions (bottom of the Game tab)

Action	When to use it
End round	No bingo and the pool's run dry, or time's up — stops playback, clears cards, marks the round complete
Reset round	False start — stops playback and clears cards but keeps the same round active to start again
Next planned	Skip ahead to the next planned round
Reset event	Set every round back to unplanned (saved snapshots keep their playlists)
Clear prep cache	Wipe saved round prep for this room in this browser

Ending the night

- **Export a recap** (Settings → Recap → Export JSON): rounds, songs played, winners — handy for prize records.
- **Close the event** from the activation bar when your org tracks credits.
- **Sign out** or just close — your preferences and saved prep live in your account for next time.

9 · Quick reference & troubleshooting

The whole night on one line each

Phase	Where	You do
Plan	Rounds tab	Assign 1 or 5 playlists per round · save all
Connect	Header / Settings	Spotify + device + projector on /display/ROOM
Card rules	Game · Step 2	Pattern, lines, free space, clip length
Ready check	Game · Step 3	Checklist green · activate event
Set round	Game · Step 3	Cards deal + call list on projector · explain round
Play	Game (live)	Start game · pause/replay/skip as needed
Bingo	Verification modal	Review card · approve or reject
Repeat	Round complete modal	Prepare next round → set → start
Wrap	Settings	Export recap · close event

Troubleshooting

Symptom	Fix
Device shows "idle"	That's fine — Start game activates it. Or use the Activate device button in Connection.
Device missing from list	Open Spotify on it, press play/pause once, tap Refresh devices.
Spotify "having trouble" while loading playlists	Usually a temporary Spotify hiccup — TEMPO retries and falls back to cached tracks. Wait a moment and rebuild the pool.
Projector looks stale after changes	Hard-refresh the display browser tab (Ctrl+Shift+R).
Round won't save / start	Check the playlist count — exactly 1 or exactly 5, nothing else.
Player joined late, no card	Cards deal at Set round; if the round is already set, they receive a card on join for that round.